

MOMS ON CALL™

Solid Food Progression | 7-12 Months

What to Expect at 7-8 Months:

Around 7-8 months of age, the baby begins to develop the “pincher grasp.” At this time, we want to begin introducing pea-sized mashable foods. In our [Solid Food Progression](#) guide, we break foods into categories, recommend new foods to try, and provide sample menus for your little one as they progress through solids!



While beginning to offer pea-sized, mashable finger foods, we are still offering a combination of baby foods (stages two and three with chunkier texture).

Introduce mashable, pea-sized bites of what you are eating. Introduce new foods over three days, so we can still be on the lookout for what they tolerate and don't.



Baby is in a high chair.

Pull that up to the table ASAP so they can begin to familiarize themselves with what mealtime looks like.



Offer breastmilk or formula in a sippy cup at all meals and snacks.

Our guide to [which sippy cups are best and why!](#)

Next: What to Expect at 9-12 Months

Sneak Peek into
the *Moms on Call*
Parenting Books and
Online Courses!



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What to Expect at 9-12 Months:

Our little one is progressing through solids, and we are beginning to share more of the foods we are eating with them!

-  At 9 months of age, continue to offer foods of a pea-sized, mushable consistency. You can include some chunky-textured baby foods too.
-  At 12 months and up, include everyday foods on their plate in bite sizes.

Offer about 3-4 bites at a time on their plate. At this age, their stomach is about the size of their own fist.

Remember to offer non-choking hazard foods (this means no hot dogs, grapes, or big apple chunks).
-  The high chair is at the table, and mealtime is with the family!

Even if you are just enjoying a snack, try and sit at the table with your little one so they can see what mealtime looks like and begin to familiarize themselves with this routine.
-  Continue to offer a sippy cup with breastmilk or formula with all snacks and meals.
-  Begin the transition to whole milk at 12 months!



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5 Tips for Developing a Healthy Relationship with Food

1. Involve all the senses!

Little ones' senses take a long time to get through a test drive. By allowing them to see, feel and explore their foods, we stimulate the initial relationship with food and understanding it.

2. Give them permission to not like stuff, and know they may change their mind without warning.

Typically introducing veggies before fruits don't work. Why? Because realistically, fruit will always taste better than veggies. But keep veggies on the menu because their appreciation for them will kick in at any time.

Continue to provide a variety of all different food groups for repeated exposure and exploration.

3. Structure the timing. Kids learn by association and routine.

Food shows up about three times a day, and the parent chooses the menu.

See [Moms on Call's Typical Day Schedules](#) for daily routines with times.

4. Keep it stress-free!

Making mealtime relaxed helps children not to associate mealtime with stress.

We know that food sensitivities can be stressful. [Learn more about introducing potential allergens.](#)

5. Stay in your lane.

It is your job to provide the food and their job to eat it!

We don't count bites, they can choose to eat it or not.

They will get the foods they need when food shows up three times a day at consistent times.